

MAX 132

GLOBAL COMMUNITY

FALL 2026

There is much controversy about what many refer to as ‘globalization’ and ‘nationalism.’ For some, globalization represents progress. Economic globalization expressed in free trade fosters economic rationality, efficiency and the promise of materially richer lives for increasing numbers of the world’s people. Cultural and informational globalization connects people in different regions of the world ever closer building a global community. In contrast, critics of globalization focus on the dangers it represents. Economic globalization concentrates wealth and political power in the hands of a few, compromises the sovereignty of nations, and threatens cultural diversity and environmental stability. They see cultural globalization as threats to national identity. Far from being of purely academic interest, these different interpretations of globalization go to the heart of domestic and international policies which determine what kind of world we live in.

MAX 132 is designed to help you become informed about these debates and explore the challenges and possibilities of a global community. This course will approach these debates from multiple academic and regional perspectives. How do economists approach these debates? How do anthropologists approach them? MAX 132 is a signature course of the Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, home to all social science disciplines—anthropology, economics, geography, history, political science and sociology. Maxwell School also houses regional experts covering the globe. MAX 132 brings together their regional expertise to help you understand what the same policy challenges look like from the perspectives of other countries.

During this semester, our aim is to sharpen your reasoning, reading, writing and speaking skills, to enhance your ability to participate as a citizen in dealing with global and national public affairs. The five specific learning objectives of MAX 132 are: (1) to increase your understanding of global political economy, global cultures, and the global environment; (2) to build your awareness of multiple perspectives on global issues; (3) to improve your critical reading and argumentation skills; (4) to help you become a more effective writer; and (5) to enable you to enter into globalization-related debates in an informed and thoughtful manner.

The course has four units. In Unit I we explore basic concepts and general debates about globalization, including who benefits most and least from the increased global interactions. In Unit II, we look at the politics of the global economy by analyzing the changing roles of governments, markets, businesses, workers, and citizens. Unit III focuses on trends and debates about globalization's cultural consequences, including whether societies worldwide are becoming more cooperative or polarized through increased interaction. Finally, Unit IV considers global environmental challenges such as climate change and the depletion of natural resources. Throughout all units, we ask what processes help or hinder the formation of ‘global communities’ capable of meeting the significant challenges of the future.

MAX 132 is included on the Basic List of the Social Sciences in the Liberal Arts Core Curriculum as defined in the Syracuse University *Undergraduate Course Catalog*. It also qualifies as a writing intensive and critical reflection course.

The course is structured around two types of meetings: plenary sessions for all students in the course and separate discussion sections. Plenaries occur on Wednesdays from 9:30 to 10:25 a.m. in Maxwell Auditorium. These consist of lectures, discussions, and videos directed by the teaching team. Small discussion sections led by one of the instructors meet twice weekly. **Please note: after the first week of classes no switching of sections is permitted.**

Your discussion section instructor will assign your grades. Two 1,200-word essays, written outside of class, together comprise 40% of the course grade. Two shorter essays of 500–600 words, written and submitted during discussion section, comprise 20% (5% for the first, 15% for the final). The remaining 40% is determined by participation, including attendance at discussion sections and plenary lectures, active contribution to class discussions, and various in-section assignments such as quizzes, summaries or critiques of readings, or other in-class writing and group activities. Attendance will be tracked for each plenary and discussion section meeting.

Classroom Rules

Democratic deliberation as well as effective learning in a classroom setting require that we show respect for each other and avoid disruptive behaviors that make it hard for others to hear and be heard. Because this is a large class, observing basic rules of courtesy is even more important for us. Therefore, we ask you to observe the following rules for participation in MAX 132. All plenary sessions will start promptly at 9:30 a.m. Please be in Maxwell Auditorium and seated before class starts. The auditorium doors close at 9:30 a.m. Once the doors close no entry is allowed.

We will be taking attendance between 9:25 and 9:30am. All electronic devices must be turned off and put away promptly at 9:30 a.m. and must stay put away until 10:25 a.m. If you believe you have a valuable reason to use a laptop during plenary, please contact the course convenor via the Center for Disability Resources.

Violation of these rules will negatively affect your participation/section grade and therefore your final grade for the course.

Eating and drinking are prohibited in Maxwell Auditorium.

All students are expected to uphold Syracuse University's 'Code of Student Conduct,' which is available online at <https://experience.syracuse.edu/community-standards/conduct-process/conduct-handbook/code-of-student-conduct/>

No-Recording and No-Sharing Policies

The instructors in MAX 132 have adopted a “no-recording” policy that strictly prohibits any unauthorized audio and/or video recording, in whole or in part, of any lecture or discussion section. In addition, class materials (PowerPoints, hand-outs, lecture videos, etc.) provided by instructors must not be distributed or otherwise shared without permission. Violations will be handled through Syracuse University’s Academic Integrity Policy. Please consult your discussion section instructor if you have any questions.

SU Academic Integrity Policy

As a pre-eminent and inclusive student-focused research institution, Syracuse University considers academic integrity at the forefront of learning, serving as a core value and guiding pillar of education. Syracuse University's Academic Integrity Policy provides students with the necessary guidelines to complete academic work with integrity throughout their studies. Students are required to uphold both course-specific and university-wide academic integrity expectations such as crediting your sources, doing your own work, communicating honestly, and supporting academic integrity. The full Syracuse University Academic Integrity Policy can be found by visiting go.syr.edu/academic-integrity, selecting, "Academic Integrity," and "Expectations and Policy."

Upholding Academic Integrity includes the protection of faculty's intellectual property. Students should not upload, distribute, or share instructors' course materials, including presentations, assignments, exams, or other evaluative materials without permission. Using websites that charge fees or require uploading of course material (e.g., Chegg, Course Hero) to obtain exam solutions or assignments completed by others, which are then presented as your own violates academic integrity expectations in this course and may be classified as a Level 3 violation. All academic integrity expectations that apply to in-person assignments, quizzes, and exams also apply online.

Students found in violation of the policy are subject to grade sanctions determined by the course instructor and non-grade sanctions determined by the School or College where the course is offered. Students may not drop or withdraw from courses in which they face a suspected violation. Any established violation in this course may result in course failure regardless of violation level.

SU AI (Artificial Intelligence) Policy

The goal of MAX 132 is to help students become better thinkers and writers. It is a writing-intensive course that teaches students how to: (i) read carefully and critically; (ii) formulate their own arguments based on the course materials; and (iii) express them logically both verbally and in writing. An artificial intelligence tool can summarize a reading, propose an argument, or generate polished prose, but in doing so, it does not make you better at doing them yourself. Consequently the course adheres to the following AI policy:

Based on the specific learning outcomes and assignments in this course, artificial intelligence is permitted on the following: only those assignments for which your discussion section instructor provides written AI instructions. See each assignment, quiz, or exam instructions for more information about what artificial intelligence tools are permitted and to what extent, as well as citation requirements. If no instructions are provided for a specific assignment, then no use of any artificial intelligence tool is permitted. Any AI use beyond that which is detailed in course assignments is explicitly prohibited except when documented permission is granted.

Artificial Intelligence cases may not be submitted to the Academic Integrity Office with AI-detection results as the only evidence of an Academic Integrity Violation.

Because MAX 132 is team-taught, the specific ways artificial intelligence may or may not be used can vary by assignment and by discussion section instructor. Students are required to follow the

specific AI instructions provided by their own instructor for each individual assignment, quiz, or exam. Students should not assume that permissions granted for one assignment, or by one instructor, extend to other assignments or other sections. When in doubt, students must ask their own instructor before using any AI tool.

Papers I and IV are written during discussion section. No electronic devices may be used during these sessions except where authorized by the Center for Disability Resources.

Disability-Related Accommodations

Students who are in need of disability-related academic accommodations must register with the Center for Disability Resources (CDR), 804 University Avenue, Room 309, 315-443-4498. Students with authorized disability-related accommodations that are relevant to MAX 132 should discuss this with their instructor. Accommodations are not provided retroactively; therefore, please contact your instructor during the first week of classes. For further information, see the Center for Disability Resources website at <https://disabilityresources.syr.edu/>

Faith Tradition Observances

Students who will miss classes because of religious holidays must notify instructors by the end of the second week of classes when they will be observing their religious holiday(s). You will find the notification form on MySlice inside of Student Services under Enrollment, click on “My Religious Observances.” The religious observances policy is found at <https://policies.syr.edu/policies/university-governance-ethics-integrity-and-legal-compliance/religious-observances-policy/>

Blackboard

This class uses Blackboard, the University's Internet-based course management system. You can access Blackboard at <https://blackboard.syracuse.edu/>. You will find the course syllabus, assignments, course announcements, additional reading assignments and reference material, discussion board, etc. on the MAX 132 M001 Blackboard site. You will also find the MAX 132 Instructional Team

All required readings must be completed prior to the assigned date, and you must be prepared to discuss the readings in discussion sections.

Your discussion instructor may also use the discussion section Blackboard course for section-specific updates, additional readings, discussion section assignments, etc. **Note:** Blackboard runs on Eastern Time; check this when submitting materials.

Information about Blackboard is available on Answers Blackboard; alternatively, you can contact Information Technology Services by sending an email to help@syr.edu, calling 315.443.2677, or in-person at the ITS Service Center, located at 1-227 CST in the Life Sciences Complex. Business hours for the Service Center can be found on the ITS Website at http://its.syr.edu/its_service_center/

Attendance

Regular attendance in plenary and section is expected. Multiple absences will affect your section grade and may result in a lower, and possibly a failing grade for the course. Further instructions regarding the attendance policy will be provided by discussion section instructors.

GRADES	DUE DATE	VALUE
In Section; participation; small assignments	Throughout semester. Details from your section instructor	40%
Paper I: 500–600-word Assignment	Completed and submitted in section on either September 9 or 10, 2026	5%
Paper II: 1200-word Essay	October 9, 2026, Friday by 11:59 pm	20%
Paper III: 1200-word Essay	November 6, 2026, Friday by 11:59 pm	20%
Paper IV: 500–600-word Final Essay	Completed and submitted in final section on either December 7 or 8, 2026	15%

Students must complete all four papers.

Turnitin®

Papers I and IV will be completed and collected in section. Papers II and III must be submitted on their due date via Turnitin®. Instructions for submitting your writing assignments will be included with each assignment. To confirm your submission either save or print out the receipt of your paper being submitted on Turnitin. Please note that while all assignments are posted on the MAX 132 main Blackboard page, they are submitted via the Turnitin® link on your discussion section page.

MAX 132 uses the Turnitin® system to detect and prevent plagiarism. Turnitin® compares submitted papers against documents on the Internet and against other student papers submitted to Turnitin® at SU and at other colleges and universities. By enrolling in MAX 132, you give your permission for those two papers that you submit online to become part of the Turnitin.com reference database solely for the purpose of detecting plagiarism of such work.

Late Assignments

Late assignments will receive reduced grades. Exceptions will be made for documented illnesses. Permission to hand in an assignment late due to illness must be received from your section leader prior to the time the assignment is due.

Effective Writing in MAX 132

Effective academic writing is a priority of this course expressed in the emphasis on four writing assignments capping each unit of the course. Professor Todd Miller, in the Department of Writing Studies, Rhetoric, and Composition, is assigned to this course to aid students in producing more effective written communication. He attends all plenary sessions and participates in some. He also reads all the assigned articles, so he is familiar with the course and its academic content. He will offer individual appointments before each major paper. In addition, any student can contact Professor Miller for an individual appointment at any time during the semester (tmille03@syr.edu). Effective writers understand that discussing their ideas and their organizational strategies can only enhance their writing skills. Students can also make an appointment for a 25- or 50-minute session with writing consultants at the Writing Center at <http://wc.syr.edu>. Please only sign up for one appointment per essay to give most students a chance to meet with the writing consultant.

Course Outline

Note: *Readings must be completed before class.*

UNIT I — Understanding Different Ideas about Global Community and Globalization

This unit introduces basic ideas and themes that we will examine throughout the course. We consider what “global community” means and how globalization plays a role in it. For each week, you will find a set of questions we will discuss in the plenary and section meetings.

Week 1: 8/24-8/28 - Introduction to MAX 132 ‘Global Community’

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 1

- Globalization is not just an abstract idea. What kind of globalization does Lustgarten’s article highlight? Who are the primary actors in his article and what are their motivations? Who benefits and who loses from globalization and why?

First Weekly Section Meeting: Get acquainted

Student introductions, instructor’s expectations, and discussion.

Wednesday Plenary 8/26: Introduction and Critical Reading and Note-Taking

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Meeting

- Lustgarten, “Palm Oil Was Supposed to Help Save the Planet. Instead, It Unleashed a Catastrophe.”

Week 2: 8/31-9/4 - What is Globalization? A Brief History

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 2

- What is globalization? Does it refer to one specific phenomenon/process? Or are there different globalizations?
- What is neo-liberalism? How is it related to globalization? What are its promises?
- Are more people in the world better-off or worse-off because of globalization? Why?
- How has the emergence of nation states shaped globalization?
- And how has the most recent wave of globalization affected nation states and nationalism?

First Weekly Section Meeting: From Spice Trade to Neoliberalism

- World Economic Forum, “A Brief History of Globalization.”
<https://www.weforum.org/stories/2019/01/how-globalization-4-0-fits-into-the-history-of-globalization/>
- BBC, The Story of India, Spice Routes and Silk Roads (the first 15 minutes)
<https://youtu.be/Y7rNMkX8ji4?si=xIHvo8onCWZsqpx1>
- Sen, “How to Judge Globalism”

Wednesday Plenary, 9/2

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Is Global Citizenship Possible?

- Appiah, “Cosmopolitanism. Ethics in a World of Strangers” (excerpts)
- Wimmer, “Why Nationalism Works and It’s not Going Away”

Week 3: 9/8-9/11— Essay Workshop Week

(NO SECTION ON LABOR DAY, 9/7)

First Weekly Section Meeting: Materials Review

Wednesday Plenary, 9/9

Second Weekly Section Meeting: In-Class Essay Writing.

UNIT II — Politics of the Global Economy

Globalization—understood as free trade and freer movement of people—has gone out of favor in the US. This unit focuses on the global political economy, examining the ways in which people

worldwide are helped and harmed through processes of production, exchange, and consumption. Since the 1980s, neoliberalism – a dominant ideology promoting trade and deregulated markets – has sparked contentious debate. Although neoliberalism emphasizes the importance of the market over the government, the neoliberal era saw the expanding role of international core institutions that managed the global economic system: The World Trade Organization (WTO), the International Monetary Fund (IMF), and the World Bank. Today, we are witnessing the breakdown of the old institutional arrangement. In this unit, you will learn to analyze the causes of the ongoing transformation of the global economy and think about possible future scenarios.

Week 4: 9/14 - 9/18— Historical Shifts in Global Economy

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 4

- How have different ideas about the relationship of markets and government shaped the past and present global political economy?
- What did the fall of the Soviet Union and the communist economic model mean for the global economy?
- How does neoliberalism intersect with geo-strategic power politics, especially regarding the US and China?

First Weekly Section Meeting: Neoliberalism and Optimism

- Friedman, “Free to Choose: The Power of the Market”
- Francis Fukuyama, “The End of History?” (opening paragraph and pp.10-15)

Wednesday Plenary, 9/16

Second Weekly Section Meeting: A Return to Great Power Competition

- Campbell & Ratner, “[The China Reckoning](#)” Foreign Affairs. (2018)
- Reicke, “[Resilience and Decoupling in the Era of Great Power Competition](#)” Merics. (2020)
- *OPTIONAL*: Big, Beautiful Tariffs [Podcast] <https://shorturl.at/EffGY>

Week 5: 9/21–9/25— Divisions of Global Labor and Supply Chains: Winners and Losers?

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 5

- Who benefits the most from the contemporary global economic system? Who benefits the least?
- Who is responsible for conditions in sweatshops—consumers, MNCs, governments, factory owners?
- How does the global production of food affect producers and consumers in the global North and South?

- What challenges are faced by women who are international labor migrants?

First Weekly Section Meeting: Global supply chains and global labor

- Silverstein “Shopping for Sweat: The Human Cost of a \$2.00 T-shirt”
- Romero, “Reflection on global care chains and migrant women workers”

Wednesday Plenary, 9/23

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Global structure of profit-making

- Patel, *Stuffed and Starved*: Introduction and excerpts from Chapter 3
- A documentary film, *Life and Debt*.
https://search.alexanderstreet.com/view/work/bibliographic_entity%7Cvideo_work%7Cmind-mhs-0OgMXGmnJA#/embed/object
 - Watch 6:00-13:20 & 19:30-24:30
- Dani Rodrik, “Too late to compensate free trade losers.”

Week 6: 9/28–10/2— A Changing Global Political Economy and the Global South

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 6

- Has globalization reached an inflection point?
- How is decoupling between the US and China affecting the rest of the world?
- What is the significance of China’s Belt and Road Initiative for development in the global South?

First Weekly Section Meeting: A Changing Political Economy

- Madhok, “Globalization, De-globalization, and Re-globalization”
- Siripurapu and Berman, “Industrial Policy Making a Comeback?”

Wednesday Plenary, 9/30

Second Weekly Section Meeting: The Global South and the BRI

- Larmer, “[What will China’s Green-Tech Ambitions Cost the World?](#)” NYT.
- Gupta, “[Belt And Road Reforms: Sustainability, Strategy, And Soft Power – Analysis](#)” Eurasia review news and analysis, April 27, 2025
- Bloomberg, The Myth of the Chinese Debt Trap in Africa (Youtube video—link available on Blackboard) https://youtu.be/_QDEWwSkP0?si=Sgi2ei9swg-4BenS

Week 7: 10/5– 10/9— Technology and AI

First Weekly Section Meeting: Technology and Creative Destruction?

- Rotman, "[People are worried that AI will take everyone's jobs. We've been there before.](#)"
- Jones, "[Joseph Stiglitz warns of the looming inequality amid AI monopoly power.](#)"

Wednesday Plenary, 10/7: Student Forum

Second Weekly Section Meeting - Essay Workshop

 **Unit II 1,200-Word Essay due Friday, October 9, 2026, 11:59 pm EST**

Unit III — Globalization, Culture and Identity

This unit explores debates regarding cultural diversity, globalization and identity. Is globalization making world cultures more alike, or is it creating greater concern about how we differ? Is cultural diversity a sign of progress or is it a threat? Are some types of cultural globalization easier to embrace than others? When and why cultural diversity causes conflicts? What is the role of identity? How does religion play a role? We will explore these questions by looking at the case studies from France, Germany, India and Iran. Finally, the unit examines broader outcomes related to globalization such as the future of democracy.

Week 8: 10/14–10/16 — Globalization, Culture & Identities

(FALL BREAK OCT 12–13)

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 8

- What does Maalouf mean when he says that his identity has "many ingredients"? What is identity, and what happens when identities are threatened?
- How can cultural identities and inequality contribute to the likelihood of violence?
- Are different religions like different cultures? Can people of different faiths co-exist peacefully?

NO First Weekly Section Meeting: Fall Break Oct 12 & 13

Wednesday Plenary 10/14

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Theorizing Cultural Globalization and Politicization of Identity

- Maalouf, "In the Name of Identity," part I.
- Holton, "Globalization's Cultural Consequences"
- Scott, "Ottoman Odyssey," read xix-xxiii (5 pages)
- Kaufman, "Ethnicity as a Generator of Conflict," 91-93.

Week 9: 10/19–10/23 — Contested Identities in India and Globalization

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 9

- How did colonialism give rise to ethnic nationalism in India?
- How has globalization contributed to ethnic nationalism in India?
- How and why does religion become a tinderbox due to globalization and ethnic nationalism?
- What role does the Internet play in giving rise to ethnic nationalism?
- What role does caste play in India, in Hindu nationalism, and in the US?

First Weekly Section Meeting: The Origin and Impact of Hindu Nationalism and its Global Implications

- Leidig, “Hindutva as a Variant of Right-Wing Extremism” (abridged)
- Video: [A New Brand of Hindu Extremism is Going Global | Decade of Hate - YouTube](#)
- Jasanoff, “Narendra Modi Is Not Who America Thinks He Is” (NYT op-ed)

Wednesday Plenary 10/21

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Caste and Hindu Nationalism in Global Context

- Martin, “Suraj’s Shadow: Where He Goes his Caste Follows, Even in America.” Podcast, episode 1.
- Martin, “No Escape from Caste.” Podcast, episode 2
- Udupa, “Internet Hindus” (abridged)

Week 10: 10/26–10/30 — Complexities of French Muslim Identity and the Politics over Hijab: State, Religion and Colonial Legacies

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 10

- What is the French concept of *laïcité*, and why has hijab become so politicized?
- Is *laïcité* the major reason for France’s problems with Muslim immigrants? Or are there other reasons?
- Hijab has become politicized in Iran in a different way. When does a religious symbol become politicized?

First Weekly Section Meeting- Colonial Legacy and the French Identity

- “Legacy of Colonialism in France,” Video (link available on Blackboard)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dc0abqW6zkc>
- Ahmed, “Journey into Europe: Islam, Immigration, and Identity” (excerpts)
- Porter, “A fatal shooting and a hijab ban” (NYT)

Wednesday Plenary, 10/28

Second Weekly Section Meeting- Hijab as a different symbol in France and Iran

- BBC, “[Iranian women reject hijabs despite morality police return.](#)”
- Arab and Maleki. “The Secular-Religious Divide in Iran: An Analysis of GAMAAN’s Online Surveys”

Week 11: 11/2–11/6 — Immigrants, Refugees and Socio-Cultural Integration in France and Germany

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 11

- What are the key differences between Germany and France when it comes to immigrant integration? How important are economics and religion?
- What conditions lead to better integration of immigrants from other countries and cultures?
- Can a country maintain a “national identity” while embracing the cultural heritage of immigrants and refugees?

First Weekly Section Meeting- Syrian Refugees in Germany

- [A power struggle’: What lies behind the anger in France’s banlieues?](#) (a video)
- Hindy, “Germany’s Syrian Refugee Integration Experiment”
- Solomon, “Meet the New Mayor”

Wednesday Plenary, 11/4

Second Weekly Section Meeting - Essay Workshop

 **Unit III 1,200-Word Essay due Friday, November 6, 2026 by 11:59 pm EST**

UNIT IV — Climate Change & Global Action/Inaction

Global environmental change is one of the most serious and controversial challenges facing humanity today. Global warming, depletion of nonrenewable resources, mismanagement of renewable resources, pollution and other trends threaten lives, livelihoods, and lifestyles. Yet, uncertainty and conflicting interests create tensions about how to respond to these environmental

challenges. Not everyone is threatened to the same extent, while nations, communities, and their members differ in their capacity for responding or adapting to them. Who is responsible for causing/creating these challenges? What can be done? We will investigate some of the causes, how different people worldwide are impacted by environmental changes, how different populations view global environmental issues, how environmental problems may contribute to conflict, and how communities and institutions attempt to foster change at the individual, local, national, and global levels.

Week 12: 11/9–11/13 — Climate Change: Causes and Consequences

Overall Objectives: To appreciate what climate change is, and its various causes; to consider its multiple consequences on human communities and the natural environment across the world.

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 12

- What is climate change?
- How are the consequences of climate change distributed across the world?
- How do communities differ in their capacity to adapt to climate change?
- How are climate change and other environmental trends connected to conflict?

First Weekly Section Meeting - Global Climate Change and Its Consequences

- Wallace-Wells, “The World Seems to Be Surrendering to Climate Change”, The New York Times, April 23, 2025.
- Council of Foreign Relations, “How climate change is a collective action problem.” (A short video. Link available on Blackboard).
<https://education.cfr.org/learn/video/collective-action-problem-climate-change>

Wednesday Plenary, 11/11

Second Weekly Section Meeting - Climate Change as Threat Multiplier

- Lustgarten 2020, “The Great Climate Migration”
- Arcanjo, “Risk and Resilience: Climate Change and Instability in the Sahel”

Week 13: 11/16–11/20 — Globalization, De-Globalization, and Climate Change

Overall Objective: To consider ways globalization and economic growth have contributed to global warming, as well as advances in renewables in such regions as South America. Conversely, de-globalization might reduce growth but also stall progress on renewables.

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 13

- What are global patterns of resource consumption, and what is their relationship to climate

change?

- What are the claims about limits to economic growth?
- How does the rise of China affect global climate actions relating to economic development and environmental sustainability?
- What roles can science and corporations play?
- How can we address overconsumption at the community and individual level?
- What are the biggest hurdles we face in tackling overconsumption in wealthy countries?

First Weekly Section Meeting: Climate and the Economy

- Monbiot, “[Capitalism is killing the planet – it’s time to stop buying into our own destruction](#)”
- Córdoba, *Stuck with Tourism*, Chapter 2 “Wild Hotspots” [Selections, do not read grayed-out.]

Wednesday Plenary, 11/18

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Actions for Sustainability

- Hickel, Degrowth can work — here’s how science can help.
- Myslikova and Dolton-Thornton, “‘Global China’ is a big part of Latin American’s renewable energy boom, but homegrown industries and ‘frugal innovation’ are key”

Week 14: 11/22–11/29 — Thanksgiving Break

- No classes!

Week 15: 11/30–12/4 — Action and Inaction: What Is to Be Done?

Overall Objective: To gain an understanding of steps taken or are being proposed at global and local (state) levels to address problems of climate change; identify and analyze the challenges that undermine collective and individual actions aimed at mitigating the causes and consequences of climate change; consider the various agencies/stakeholders that have been at the forefront to confront climate change, as well as reform in access to global financial flows to mitigate impact of extreme climatic shifts across the world; appreciate and explain the alternative green technologies that hold potential for economic growth while cutting back at CO₂ emissions.

QUESTIONS FOR WEEK 15

- What role do businesses and government play in relation to environmental change?

- How can the international community best address the problems of climate change?
- What can be done at the community and individual level to address environmental issues?
- How does leadership matter in responding to environmental concerns?
- How best can the world harness science and technology to confront, mitigate, or prevent challenges posed by global warming/climate change?

First Weekly Section Meeting: A Global Call for Action

- Damon Gameau's film, [2040](#) available on Kanopy via Syracuse Library online

Wednesday Plenary, 12/2: Student Forum

Second Weekly Section Meeting: Writing Workshop

Week 16: 12/7–12/8 — Last day of classes: Tuesday, December 8

First Weekly Section Meeting: Unit IV In-Class Final Essay